

Matthew Isbell

Senior Security Sales Specialist · Cloud & Enterprise Security · EMEA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security sales specialist with 10 plus years of experience leading consultative, quota aligned cycles from discovery through commercial close across enterprise and ISV accounts in EMEA. Currently security lead across 25 plus accounts in 10 plus countries, driving pipeline generation, competitive displacement, and expansion motions across XDR, SIEM, CNAPP, identity, and data protection. Strong commercial ownership including pricing strategy, discount governance, procurement engagement, and forecasting discipline. Deep technical grounding that accelerates executive trust and shortens evaluation cycles by translating security architecture into measurable outcomes.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Pipeline generation and qualification (MEDDPICC aligned)
- Territory planning, account plans, and opportunity strategy
- CxO level security value selling and stakeholder alignment
- Competitive displacement and objection handling
- Commercials, pricing, discount governance, and procurement negotiation
- Workshops, demos, proof of concept planning, and success criteria
- Security domains: XDR, SIEM, CNAPP, IAM, Zero Trust, data protection, security AI
- Partner co-sell motions and marketplace programs

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Technical Specialist — SDP EMEA ISV [Microsoft](#)

Apr 2025 – Present

EMEA · UK-based

- Security lead across 25 plus ISV and digital native accounts spanning 10 plus EMEA countries, owning specialist sales execution in a combined SE and security seller capacity including pipeline creation, multi threaded opportunity management, forecasting inputs, and commercial close.
- Closed a 238K dollar security expansion following a major security incident, owning the end to end deal cycle from qualification through pricing, contracting, and close, recognised by senior leadership for specialist level ownership.
- Expanded a strategic ISV from 600K dollars annual run rate to over 1.5M dollars monthly security ACR, around 60 percent year on year growth, by building an executive aligned security plan across XDR, SIEM, data protection, and security AI.
- Led cloud security pricing strategy and discount governance across 13 SKUs, securing approval for a 75 percent discount to displace a CNAPP competitor and unlock 520K dollars per month of security ACR whitespace.
- Drove a Splunk-to-Sentinel SIEM migration for a global financial services ISV, generating ~\$24K/month in new security ACR alongside parallel data protection and licensing workstreams.
- Co authored a competitive takeout pipeline identifying 1.5M dollars plus per month addressable security ACR whitespace, improving pipeline hygiene, stage discipline, and forecast accuracy across the specialist portfolio.
- Delivered in-person security workshops across Milan, Tampere, Zurich, and the Netherlands; built reusable PoC Success Criteria frameworks and executive one-pagers to accelerate deal cycles across the portfolio.
- Led competitive displacement and retention motions against CrowdStrike, Wiz, Palo Alto, SentinelOne, Splunk, and Fortinet - winning technical decisions across endpoint, SIEM, CNAPP, and identity.
- Built and ran structured account and pipeline reviews across priority deals, maintaining CRM stage hygiene, risks, next steps, and close plans to improve forecast quality and leadership visibility.

Senior Security Technical Specialist [Microsoft](#)

Dec 2017 – Mar 2025

United Kingdom

- Owned deal strategy and technical win plans in a matrix specialist model, partnering with account executives to qualify, progress, and close multi million pound security outcomes across UK central government and enterprise.
- Led executive level workshops, demos, and proof of concept engagements for Tier 1 public sector and enterprise organisations across telecoms, media, professional services, and regulated industries, engaging CISOs, CTOs, CIOs, and security leadership teams.
- Enabled MSSP partner growth by integrating SIEM and XDR into managed service offerings, creating recurring revenue expansion opportunities across the partner ecosystem.
- Managed four security apprentices across SIEM, XDR, and Zero Trust; served as UK technical community lead for security, driving field enablement and readiness across a large internal team.
- Drove net new workload adoption and expansion within existing enterprise footprints by identifying whitespace, building business value narratives, and mobilising partners and internal specialists to progress opportunities from discovery to close.

Solutions Engineer [Nexor Ltd](#)

Jun 2016 – Dec 2017

United Kingdom

- Led consultative presales cycles from discovery through proposal — delivering technical demonstrations, proofs of concept, and multi-stakeholder alignment for secure information exchange solutions in government and defence.

Technical Consultant [Deep Secure Ltd](#)

May 2013 – Jun 2016

United Kingdom

- Delivered post-sales deployment and support for secure gateway and content disarm and reconstruction solutions in regulated environments, managing escalations and on-site engagements to protect customer outcomes.

EDUCATION

MSc Forensic Computing · De Montfort University

BSc Forensic Science · University of Lincoln

HNC Electronic & Electrical Engineering · Lincoln College

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

- Microsoft Gold Club Choice Award Winner · 2024
- Copilot for Security Champion · Technical Skills Achievement · 2024
- SC-300 Identity and Access Administrator · 2024
- SC-200 Security Operations Analyst Associate · 2022
- MS-500 Microsoft Security Administrator Associate · 2019
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) · EC-Council · 2020

LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Member, British Computer Society (BCS)
- Liveryman, Worshipful Company of Information Technologists (WCIT)

References available upon request.